

someone go to the National Vulnerability Database (NVD) to check if there's anything there that matches the open source on the spreadsheet.

Q Last year, Red Hat and Black Duck announced a partnership. How can this be fruitful for enterprises?

Containers are attractive to enterprise customers because they are development accelerators. Black Duck is partnering with Red Hat to enable secure use of Linux containers.

Red Hat has a container offering called OpenShift, which works as a Platform-as-a-Service (PaaS). A container has a base operating system, which is usually a stripped down version of a Linux package, and Red Hat Linux Enterprise (RHEL) is running the whole thing. The container has a base layer and an application server like TomCat. Additionally, it might have Java, possibly a database, and then an open source based application on top. What Red Hat realised is that with Black Duck, its customers would have excellent visibility into everything inside of those containers. We can look at all the container pieces as well as the base operating system. We can tell you if there are vulnerabilities in that version of the operating system, and can inform you if a vulnerability exists that can be patched.

While our competitors can only tell you that there could be vulnerabilities in the container, we can show whether there are real vulnerabilities or if they've already been patched. And then we monitor everything over the lifecycle of the container. All of this helps Red Hat's customers ensure that their containers are free from licence and security risks.

Q How does Black Duck drive developer engagement in open source deployments?

We have a free project called OpenHub that aggregates information about open source projects. There are about 600,000 open source developers and users as a part of the OpenHub community, and a significant number of active contributors. It's a great tool for analysing the strength of an open source based project. This is important, because if you're relying on a piece of open source software that doesn't have a vibrant community, it's going to be much harder to get somebody to help you fix it when problems surface. Typically, you'll be left trying to fix it by yourself. If a project has an active community, it will be regularly patched and improved. We help you find the one that's going to be the best fit, with the most active community.

OpenHub is free for developers and is open for anybody who wants to search for particular information. Also, people who manage projects are free to put their information in it, so they can ensure that their offerings get visibility.

We recently started to show security information on OpenHub as well; so the same value we bring to our commercial customers, we offer the open source community.

Q Black Duck already has a strong presence in the US, UK, Europe and Japan. When can we see its expansion in India?

We're investing in India because of its market opportunities and tech sophistication. Some of the biggest and the most important companies in the world are developing software in India, so it's a natural fit for Black Duck to be here and help them with their open source security and management.

Q What is your go-to-market strategy for the Indian market?

We have direct sales here. We also sell through our partners. We have a strong relationship with companies such as IBM, Red Hat and HP, who have a large presence in India.

Q The Indian government is supporting enterprises with programmes like 'Digital India' and 'Make in India'. How is Black Duck contributing to these initiatives?

We're supportive of the government's initiatives and will help them in any way we can. Starting a business today and getting to market quickly requires the use of open source. That's true not only in India but also across the globe. Our free OpenHub project is a resource Black Duck provides to help startups and other companies responsibly choose open source software. This platform allows developers to research what open source is available for the task at hand, assess the value of projects that address their needs, and understand how much support each open source community provides.

Q Do you think open source will reach even greater heights in the future?

Open source usage is ubiquitous. It's everywhere. Once looked at with skepticism, open source is simply the way we develop software today. It will continue to be the engine for innovation and the pace of adoption will increase. 